2025 Lawn & Tree Care Guide

Yukon, Oklahoma | Bermuda Grass | Elm Trees

Month-by-month schedule for a weed-free, pest-free, lush lawn

Quick-Reference Summary

Category	Key Dates / Products
Mow height	1" spring/fall → 1.5" summer peak
Dethatch	Late April – early May (before you do it, mow low)
Pre-emergent	Early March (done) + Sept for winter weeds
Fertilizer	May, July, Sept **|** Use 32-0-10 or 28-0-3 for Bermuda
Elm beetle drench	Apply imidacloprid NOW (late March) — roots need 3-4 wks
Elm pruning	Late winter (Feb) or mid-summer (July) — avoid spring sap flow
Wild onions	Image/Sedgehammer + methylated seed oil surfactant, repeat
Dallisgrass	Tenacity (mesotrione) or hand pull; pre-emergent Feb-March
Perimeter spray	Monthly April–Oct; re-apply after rain

Your Specific Weed Challenges

Weed	Why It's Tough	Best Solution
Wild Onions	Waxy leaf coating repels most sprays. Bulbs survive even if top is killed.	Image (imazaquin) or Sedgehammer + methylated seed oil surfactant. Apply when temps 60-80°F. Repeat every 3 weeks. Do not mow 2 days before/after.
Dallisgrass	Perennial with deep rhizomes. Hand pulling leaves root fragments that regrow.	Tenacity (mesotrione) is safest on Bermuda — repeat 3x every 3 weeks. Pull clumps before seed heads form. No MSMA available to homeowners.
Crabgrass	Annual — germinates when soil hits 55°F (late Feb/March in Yukon).	Pre-emergent (prodiamine/pendimethalin) by March 1 is your best tool. Post-emergent: Drive XLR8 or Tenacity on young crabgrass.
Clover	Broadleaf. Can indicate low nitrogen.	Any broadleaf herbicide with triclopyr (Ortho Weed B Gon, Spectracide Weed Stop). Add surfactant. Boost nitrogen fertilizing to crowd it out.

■ **Always add a methylated seed oil (MSO) surfactant to wild onion treatments — without it the herbicide beads off the waxy surface and does almost nothing.**

Your Elm Trees — Annual Care Overview

Your elms are in a critical transition phase — large enough to be attractive beetle hosts, but still young enough that heavy defoliation can cause real long-term stress. The imidacloprid soil drench you ordered is the single best investment you can make. Below is the full annual care framework.

Task	Timing	Details
Soil drench (beetle prevention)	Late March – April	Apply imidacloprid per label around drip line + base. Needs 3-4 weeks to translocate. One application covers full season. Keep moist after applying.
Pruning	Feb (dormant) or July (mid-summer)	Remove dead, crossing, or weak branches. Avoid pruning in spring when sap is flowing and wound response is weakest. For young trees, focus on establishing a strong central leader.
Fertilizing	April and September	Use a balanced slow-release tree fertilizer (10-10-10 or similar). Young transitioning trees benefit most. Apply at drip line, water in well.
Mulching	April (maintain all season)	2-3" of mulch around base (not touching trunk) retains moisture, moderates soil temp, and protects roots. Critical for young trees in Oklahoma summer heat.
Beetle monitoring	May – August	Even with drench, monitor weekly for skeletonized leaves (sign of larvae feeding). If you see damage despite drench, supplement with pyrethrin spray on affected branches.
Watering	May – September	Deep water 1x/week during dry spells. Young transitioning elms are more drought-sensitive than mature ones. Drought stress worsens beetle damage and slows drench uptake.
Fall check	October	Inspect for borers, cankers, or fungal growth before dormancy. Address any wounds with pruning sealer. Clean up fallen leaves to reduce overwintering beetle populations.

Month-by-Month Schedule

JANUARY — Dormant Season Planning

Lawn

- Bermuda is fully dormant — no mowing, fertilizing, or weed treatments needed
- Good time to sharpen mower blades and service your push mower
- Map out where Dallisgrass and wild onion patches were — plan your spring attack
- Order pre-emergent (prodiamine or pendimethalin) if not already stocked
- Monitor for winter weeds (henbit, chickweed) — treat with broadleaf herbicide on warm days above 50°F

Elm Trees

- Ideal pruning window — trees are fully dormant, beetles inactive, disease risk minimal
- Remove dead, crossing, or rubbing branches
- For young elms: establish or reinforce a single dominant central leader
- Do NOT fertilize dormant trees

Pest/Perimeter

- Indoor perimeter spray still useful for overwintering insects
- No outdoor granule applications needed

FEBRUARY — Pre-Season Prep

Lawn

- Apply pre-emergent herbicide (prodiamine/pendimethalin) by end of February
- Target: crabgrass, Dallisgrass seed, annual weeds — soil temps approaching 50-55°F
- Do NOT aerate or dethatch yet — too early, Bermuda still dormant
- Avoid weed-and-feed products yet — Bermuda not actively absorbing
- Hand pull any Dallisgrass rosettes you can find before they seed

Elm Trees

- Complete any remaining dormant pruning before buds break (late Feb deadline)
- Apply dormant oil spray if scale insects were a problem in prior years
- Plan your imidacloprid soil drench purchase if not already ordered

Pest

- Check indoor perimeter seal — reapply Spectracide liquid if needed before insects activate

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MARCH — Green-Up Begins (YOU ARE HERE)

Lawn

- Bermuda begins green-up mid-to-late March in Yukon — start first mow when ~50% green
- First mow: set to lowest setting (1" or below) to scalp dormant material and stimulate new growth — DONE
- Weed-and-feed application this month is well-timed — DONE
- Spot spray broadleaf weeds with triclopyr-based product — DONE
- Begin wild onion treatment: Image or Sedgehammer + methylated seed oil surfactant
- Hand pull Dallisgrass clumps as they emerge — the smaller the better
- Do NOT apply nitrogen fertilizer yet — wait until lawn is 75%+ green

Elm Trees

- Apply imidacloprid soil drench NOW (late March is ideal window) — ORDERED
- Water the drench in well and keep soil moist for 2 weeks to aid uptake
- Beetles become active in April/May — you need 3-4 weeks for translocation
- Begin light inspection of branches for overwintering egg masses (oval, yellowish clusters under leaves)

Pest

- Begin outdoor perimeter spray as temps consistently hit 50°F+
- Spread Triazicide granules around lawn perimeter and tree bases

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APRIL — Active Growth, Dethatch Month

Lawn

- Continue mowing at low setting (1-1.25") through dethatching
- DETHATCH: target late April when Bermuda is actively growing and can recover quickly
- Use dethatching blade on mower — far more effective than rake for Bermuda
- After dethatching: water deeply, light fertilizer application, let it recover 1-2 weeks before next mow
- Second wild onion treatment (3 weeks after first) — critical to repeat for bulb kill
- Apply post-emergent crabgrass killer (Drive XLR8 or Tenacity) on any visible young plants
- Keep hand pulling Dallisgrass — do not let it reach seed-head stage

Fertilizer

- First real fertilizer of the year after dethatch recovery
- Use a Bermuda-specific formula: look for high nitrogen, low phosphorus — 32-0-10 or 28-0-3 work well
- Avoid cheap generic blends with high phosphorus — Bermuda rarely needs it
- Apply at label rate with spreader; water in within 24 hours

Elm Trees

- Imidacloprid should now be reaching full distribution through tree
- Apply 2-3" mulch around base of each elm (keep away from trunk)
- Fertilize trees: slow-release 10-10-10 at drip line, watered in
- Watch for elm leaf beetle adults appearing on foliage — small yellowish-green beetles

Pest

- Monthly outdoor perimeter spray — all doors, windows, garage, eaves
- Spread Triazicide granules in yard and around tree bases
- Begin checking under eaves and deck for wasp nest starts — address early

MAY — Peak Spring, Step Up Mowing

Lawn

- Bermuda fully active — increase mowing frequency to every 5-7 days
- Begin stepping mow height up: move to 1.5" once lawn has fully recovered from dethatch
- Continue Dallisgrass hand pulling — persistence is key (you noted improvement each year)
- Third wild onion treatment if plants are still visible — repeat every 3 weeks until gone
- Spot spray clovers and broadleaf weeds with triclopyr; add surfactant

Fertilizer

- Second fertilizer application mid-May
- Same Bermuda formula (32-0-10 or 28-0-3) — this feeds peak growing season
- If lawn looks pale/yellowing between fertilizer rounds, a light iron supplement (chelated iron spray) greens it up without pushing excess growth

Elm Trees

- Peak beetle season begins — inspect leaves weekly
- Look for skeletonized leaves (larvae feeding) or shot-hole damage (adults)
- If damage appears despite drench, spot-spray with pyrethrin on affected branches
- Ensure trees are getting 1" of water per week during dry spells

Pest

- Monthly perimeter spray — increase frequency to every 3 weeks if ant pressure is high
- Triazicide granules in yard — focus on moist/shaded areas where pests concentrate

JUNE — Early Summer, Heat Building

Lawn

- Mowing height: move to 1.5-2" as summer heat increases
- Bermuda handles heat well but scalping it during a heat wave causes stress — stay above 1.5"
- Mow every 5-7 days; never remove more than 1/3 of blade height per cut
- Water deeply 2-3x per week if no rain — Bermuda needs 1-1.5" per week in summer
- Dallisgrass: continue weekly hand pulling; apply Tenacity if patches are large
- Crabgrass should be controlled if pre-emergent was applied — spot treat stragglers

Fertilizer

- Light fertilizer mid-June if lawn color is fading
- Potassium (K) matters in summer heat — look for formulas with K (the third number)
- Avoid over-fertilizing in peak heat — can burn and force growth the lawn can't sustain

Elm Trees

- Peak beetle monitoring month — inspect every 7-10 days
- Maintain weekly deep watering on young elms
- Avoid any pruning this month — trees are under metabolic stress from heat

Pest

- Monthly perimeter spray — very active month for ants, roaches, spiders
- Check for armyworm activity in lawn (watch for birds feeding heavily in one area — sign of infestation)
- If grubs are suspected (spongy lawn, brown patches), treat with a grub control product (imidacloprid or chlorantranilip role)

JULY — Peak Summer

Lawn

- Mowing height: 2" is a good balance between your preference for height and Bermuda's needs
- Continue deep, infrequent watering — shallow frequent watering encourages shallow roots
- Avoid herbicide applications during heat stress (above 90°F) — can burn lawn
- Stay on top of Dallisgrass hand pulling — this is when it seeds aggressively

Fertilizer

- Third fertilizer application — mid-July
- This is the most important summer feed — Bermuda is growing hard
- Use same high-nitrogen Bermuda formula; water in well

Elm Trees

- Safe pruning window reopens mid-July through August — heat slows sap flow
- Remove any storm-damaged branches promptly
- Continue weekly deep watering on young trees
- If beetle damage is visible despite drench, pyrethrin spray is appropriate — target undersides of leaves where larvae feed

Pest

- Monthly perimeter spray — don't skip in peak summer; insect pressure is highest
- Check for and treat fire ant mounds that appear after rain
- Triazicide granules mid-July around trees and perimeter

AUGUST — Late Summer Wind-Down

Lawn

- Begin stepping mow height back down — drop from 2" toward 1.5" by end of August
- Watch for brown patch fungus in humid weeks — circular brown rings in lawn
- Reduce fertilizer — avoid heavy nitrogen this close to dormancy
- Continue Dallisgrass removal — last chance before fall seed drop

Fertilizer

- Light potassium-focused application only if lawn looks stressed
- Skip nitrogen if temps stay high — feeding nitrogen late risks winter kill

Elm Trees

- Last window for summer pruning — wrap up by mid-August
- Reduce watering slightly as heat moderates
- Begin winding down beetle monitoring — adult activity drops off

Pest

- Monthly perimeter spray
- Watch for cricket and earwig pressure as they seek shelter before fall

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SEPTEMBER — Fall Prep, Key Weed Window

Lawn

- Apply second pre-emergent of the year — targets winter annual weeds (henbit, poa annua)
- Timing: before soil cools below 70°F, typically mid-September in Yukon
- Final fertilizer of the year — use a winterizer formula (low nitrogen, high potassium)
- Look for 8-0-24 or 13-0-44 'winterizer' — potassium builds root reserves for winter
- Mow height: step back down to 1.25-1.5" to reduce thatch going into dormancy
- Spot spray any visible broadleaf weeds — they're easier to kill in cooler temps

Elm Trees

- Fall fertilizer application: slow-release 10-10-10 at drip line
- This feeds root growth heading into fall — roots continue growing after leaves drop
- Clean up fallen leaves around tree base to reduce overwintering beetle habitat
- Begin planning Feb pruning — note any branches to address

Pest

- Monthly perimeter spray — insects seeking overwintering shelter
- Seal any entry points: gaps around pipes, vents, door sweeps
- Triazicide granule application around perimeter and tree bases

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OCTOBER — Dormancy Approaching

Lawn

- Final mow of the season — cut to 1-1.25" for last mow before dormancy
- Bermuda will go dormant after first frost (typically late October/early November in Yukon)
- Do not fertilize after mid-October
- Dallisgrass: hand pull any remaining plants before frost; mark large patches for spring
- Rake and remove heavy leaf deposits from elm trees — thatch buildup and disease risk

Elm Trees

- Inspect for borers, cankers, or unusual bark damage before dormancy
- Note any large limbs needing removal for Feb pruning
- Apply tree wound sealer to any open wounds
- Remove and dispose of heavily infested leaf debris to reduce beetle egg overwintering

Pest

- Final perimeter spray before cold sets in
- Focus on sealing interior — roaches, spiders, mice look for entry points
- Check bidet/sink/toilet areas for moisture-driven pest activity going into winter

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NOVEMBER – DECEMBER — Dormant Season

Lawn

- No mowing, fertilizing, or herbicide applications
- Winter weeds (henbit, chickweed) may still be treated on warm days above 50°F
- Use downtime to review what worked and plan next year's product purchases
- Service mower, sharpen blades, winterize equipment
- Consider a soil test ($15-20 through OSU Extension) to dial in next year's fertilizer exactly

Elm Trees

- Trees fully dormant — ideal observation time for structural issues
- Plan and schedule February pruning
- Order next year's imidacloprid soil drench so you have it ready in March

Pest

- Maintain indoor perimeter spray monthly
- Check crawl spaces and garage for overwintering pest activity
- Stock up on spring products: pre-emergent, Triazicide, imidacloprid, surfactant, Sedgehammer/Image

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Dialing In Your Fertilizer

Bermuda grass has specific nutritional needs that generic lawn fertilizer often misses. Here is a specific schedule with product guidance to replace the 'whatever is on sale' approach.

Application	Timing	Ratio to Look For	Why
1st — Green-Up Feed	Late April (post-dethatch)	32-0-10 or 28-0-3	High N to push growth, low/no P (Bermuda rarely needs phosphorus), some K for stress tolerance
2nd — Spring Feed	Mid-May	32-0-10 or similar	Feeds peak growing season. Most important application of the year.
3rd — Summer Feed	Mid-July	32-0-10 or 28-0-3	Sustains color and density through heat. Water in immediately.
4th — Winterizer	Mid-September	8-0-24 or 13-0-44	Low N, high K. Builds root reserves and cold hardiness going into dormancy.
Tree Fertilizer	April + September	10-10-10 slow release	Balanced feed for young transitioning elms at both growing windows.

Note: Specific products to look for: Lesco 32-0-10, Scotts Turf Builder Bermudagrass, Ewing 28-0-3, or Anderson's 16-0-8. For winterizer: Lesco 8-0-24 or Scotts Green Max with potassium. OSU Extension also offers a free soil test interpretation service — worth doing once to calibrate.

■ A soil test from the OSU Extension office (~$15) will tell you your exact N/P/K needs and pH. Oklahoma soils often have adequate phosphorus already — over-applying it can actually lock out other nutrients.